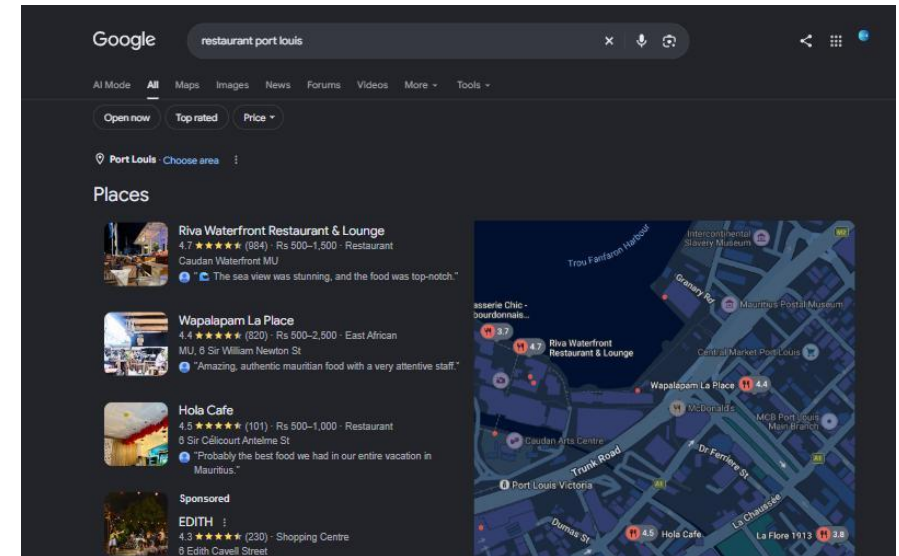


WEEK 3 · DIGITAL MARKETING & AI BOOTCAMP

SEO Fundamentals

How do people in Mauritius find a business on Google, Google, on Maps and in AI answers, and how do you you make sure it's yours?

SEO · AEO · GEO



TODAY

Agenda

1



What SEO is
and how Google works

2



Reading Google
ads, map, results, AI answers

3



Keywords
what Mauritians really type

4



The pillars
on-page, technical, local, reviews
reviews

5



SEO + AI
AEO and GEO

6



Your turn
exercises and homework

Think about the last time you looked for...



A restaurant

Where did you look? Google, Maps, Facebook, a friend?



A service

A plumber, a gym, a garage...
what did you type?



An answer

Did you ask Google, or ChatGPT?

Whoever shows up first gets the customer. That's SEO.

SEO = being found, understood and trusted



Found

Google can reach your pages and your business listing.



Understood

Google knows what you offer, where, and for whom.



Trusted

Reviews, links and mentions show you are real and good.

SEO = Search Engine Optimisation. Clicks from the free ("organic") results cost nothing per visit, and they keep coming even when you stop paying for ads. Today Google's AI answers, ChatGPT and Gemini also use the same signals.

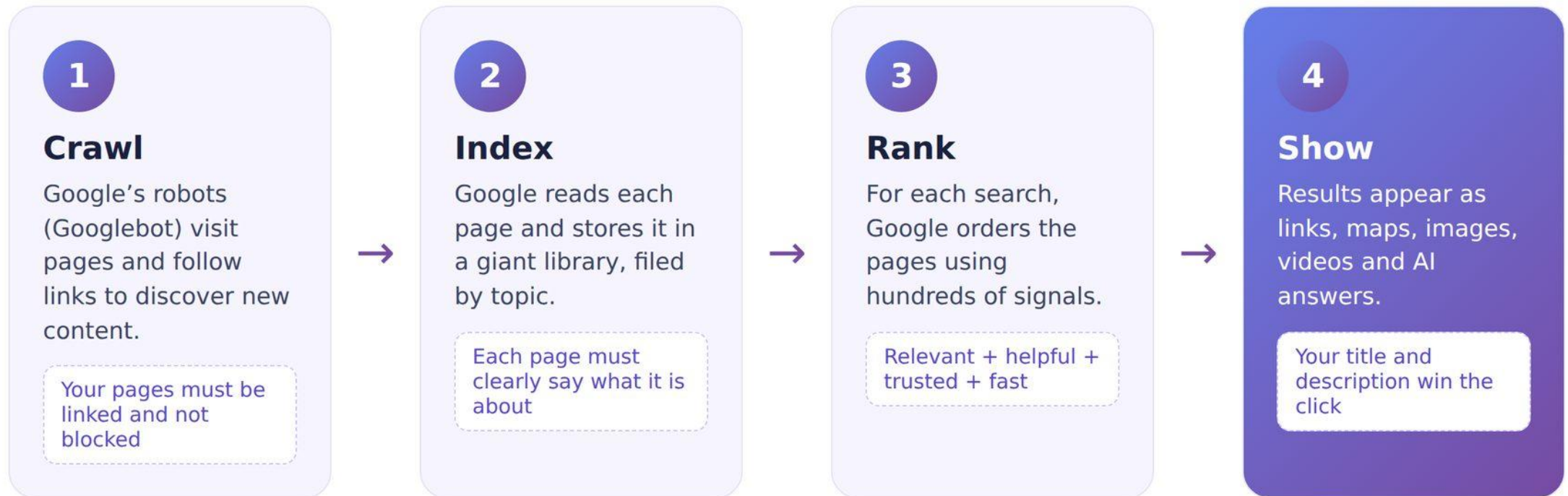
SEO vs Google Ads

	Google Ads (paid)	SEO (free)
Cost	Pay for every click	Free clicks
Speed	Same day	Weeks to months
When you stop	You disappear	Results keep working
Best for	Offers, quick tests	Long-term visitors

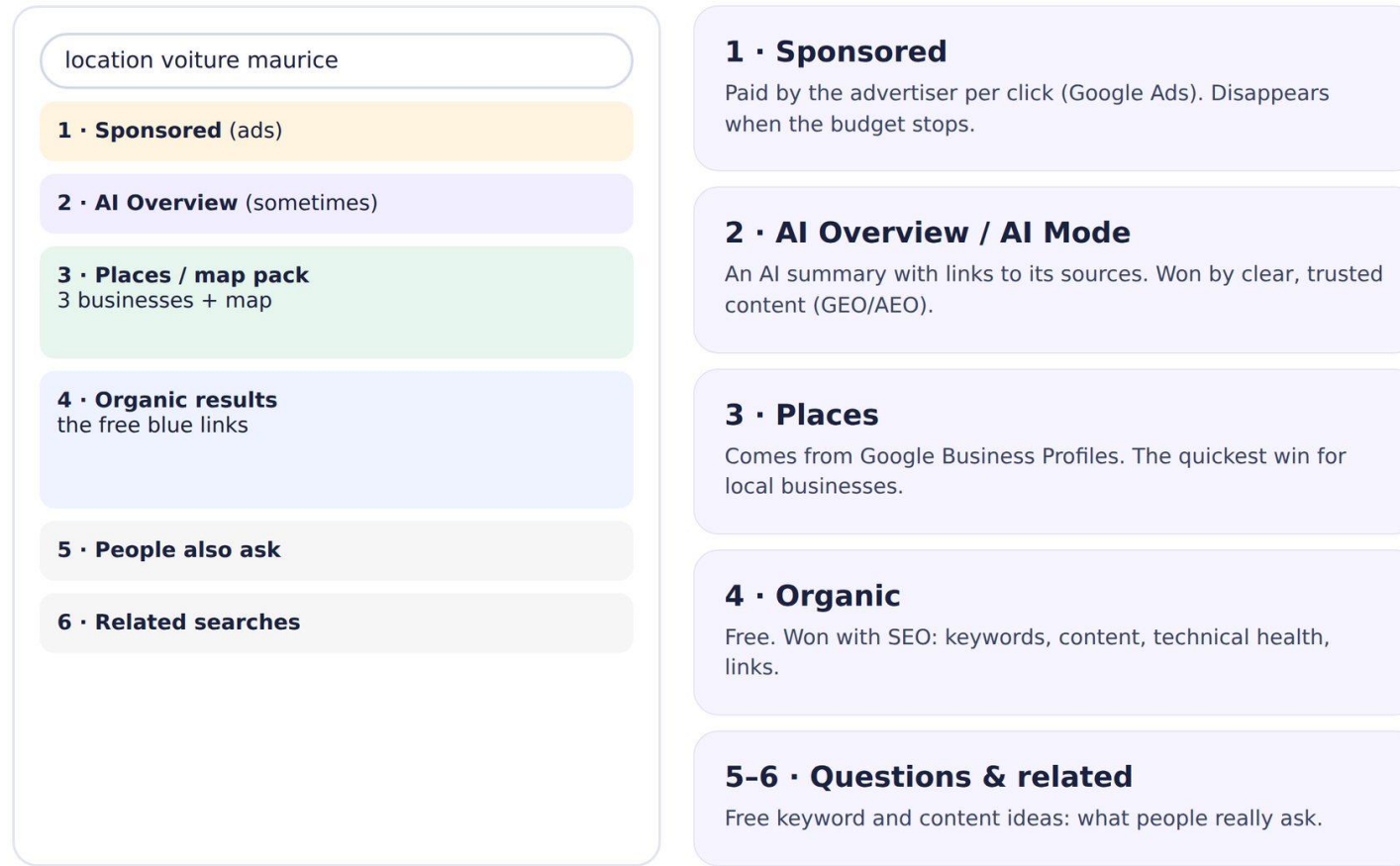
They work best together: ads while SEO builds up. Google Ads = Weeks 6 and 7.

How Google works in 4 steps

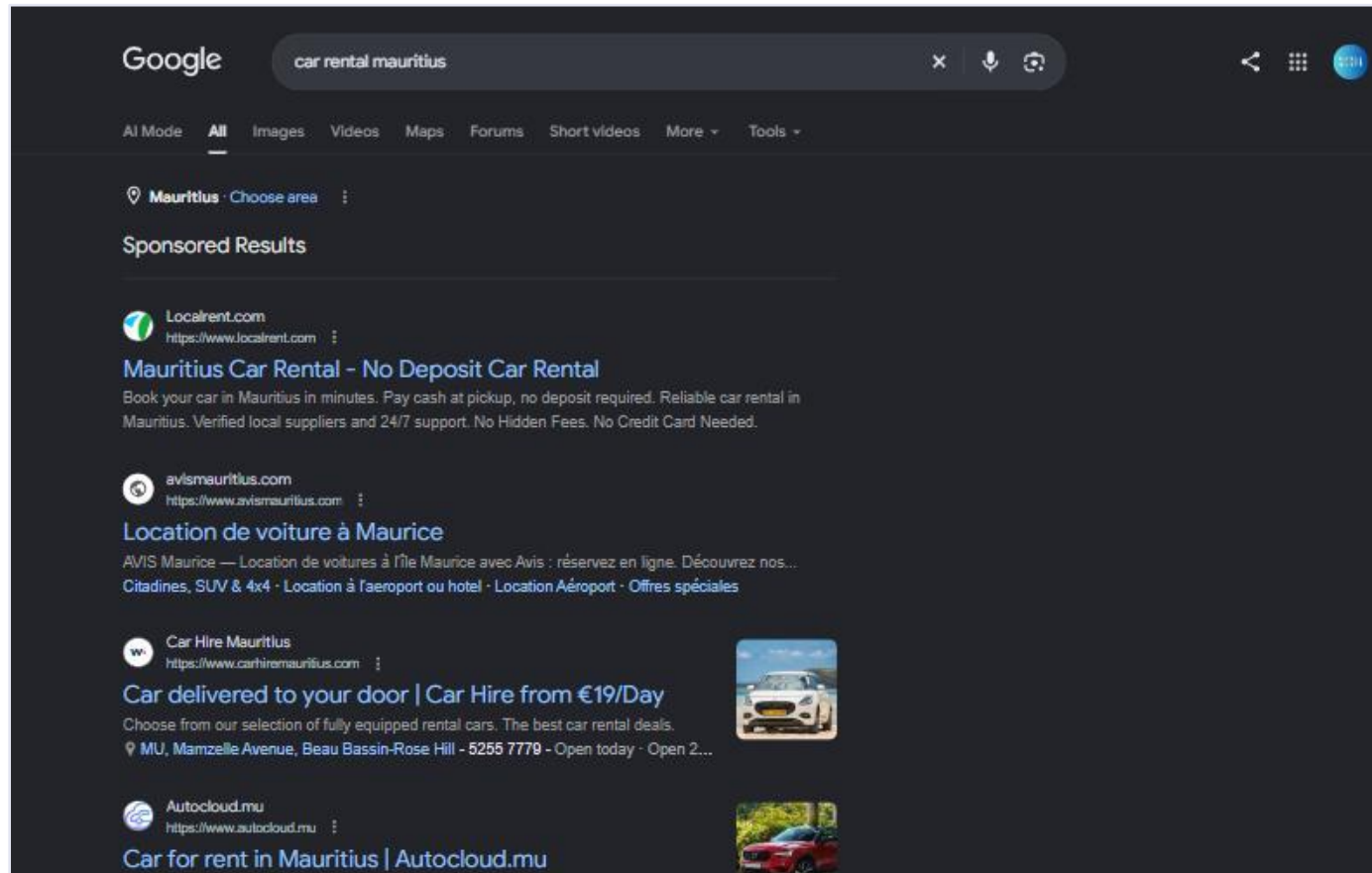
Like a giant library: collect, file, choose, show.



The parts of a results page



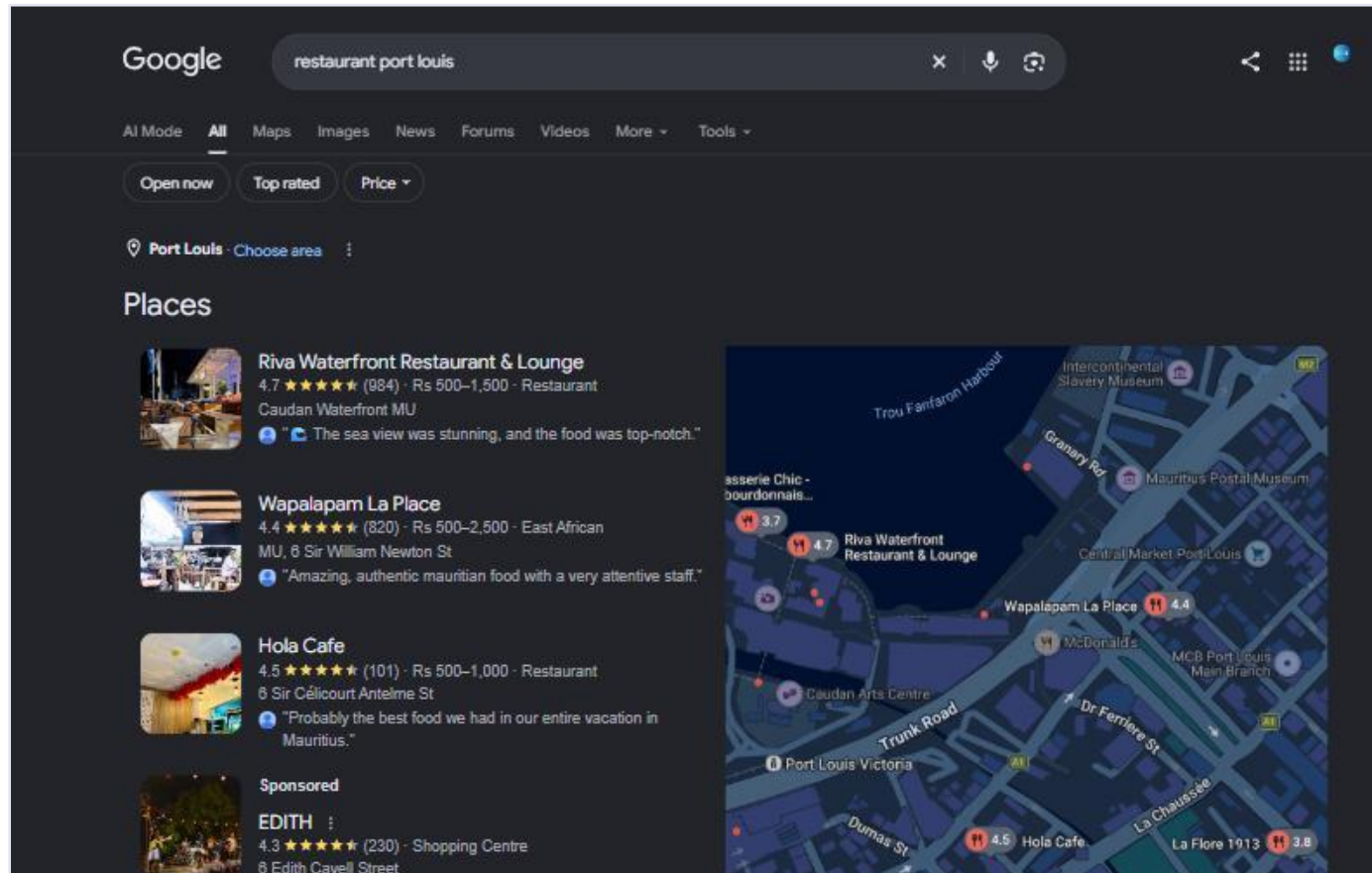
A commercial search: ads first



- The whole first screen is ads from Localrent, Avis, Car Mauritius, Autocloud
- Big budgets compete here
- Scroll down and the map appears next
- Small agencies can still win on Maps and on specific searches

google.mu · "car rental mauritius"

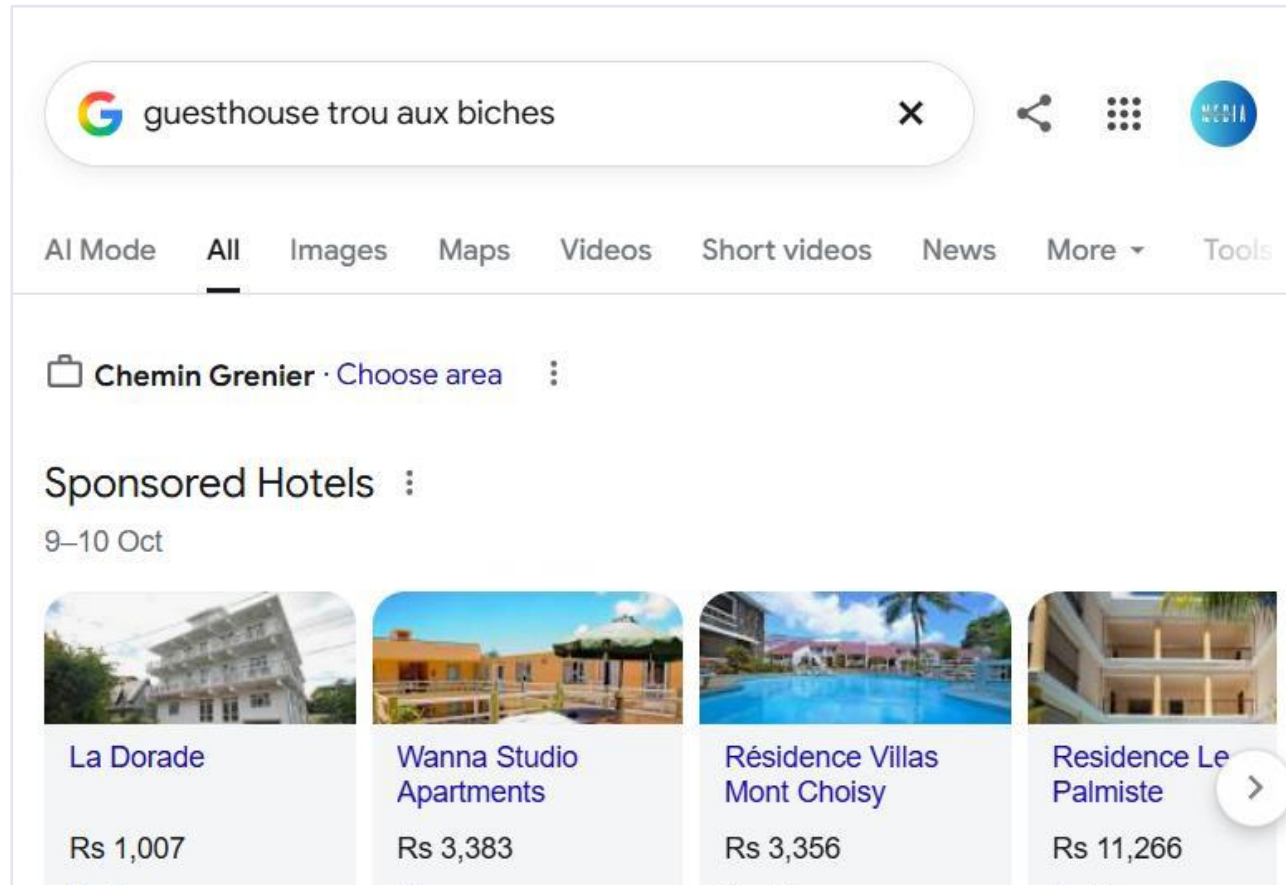
A local search: the map comes first



- No ads at the top: Google goes straight to Places
- Stars, number of reviews, price and and a review quote show right away away
- Riva Waterfront: 4.7★ with 984 reviews
- Filters: Open now, Top rated, Price Price

google.mu · "restaurant port louis"

Big platforms win broad searches



google.mu · "guesthouse trou aux biches"

- Sponsored hotels with prices in rupees come first
- Below: Booking.com, Tripadvisor, Tripadvisor, Agoda
- A small guesthouse can't beat them on this search
- Win instead on Maps, on specific searches, and with great reviews on those platforms

Customers don't talk like brochures

What the business writes	What the customer types
"Boutique coastal accommodation"	guesthouse trou aux biches
"Premium vehicle hire solutions"	location voiture maurice pas cher
"Authentic street-food concept"	dholl puri near me
"Bespoke celebration patisserie"	birthday cake mauritius

A keyword is the words people type or say. Start from your customer's words, not yours.

Why is the person searching?

KNOW

Learn something

best time to visit mauritius
how to register a business in mauritius

Best page: guide, blog article, FAQ

GO

Reach a specific site

mcb internet banking
wapalapam la place

Best page: home page, brand page

LOCAL

Find a place nearby

dholl puri near me
gym quatre bornes

Best page: Google Business Profile + location page

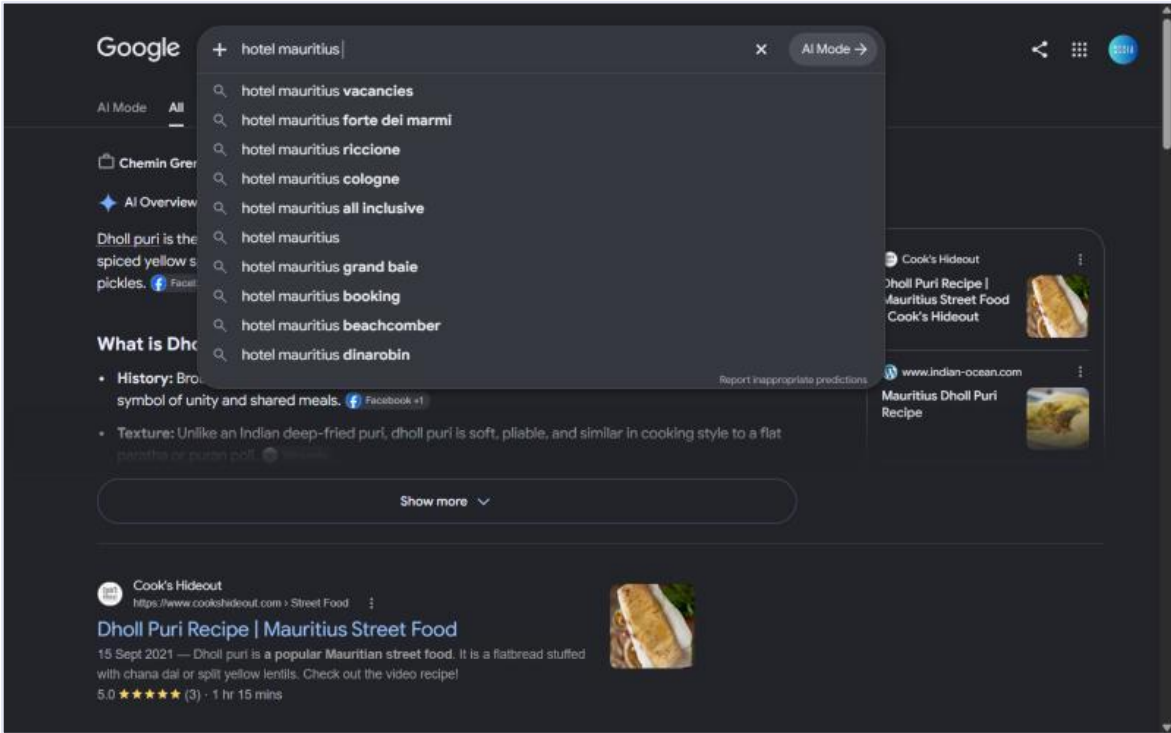
DO / BUY

Act now

location voiture maurice pas cher
wedding cake mauritius delivery

Best page: service, product or booking page

What Mauritians really type



Broad keywords are ambiguous: "hotel mauritius" also suggests hotels named named Mauritius in Italy and Germany.

You type...	Google suggests...
location voiture maurice	...aéroport · ...pas cher · ...sans caution
restaurant grand baie	...pas cher · ...halal · ...bord de mer
gym quatre bornes	ladies gym... · ...reviews · ...photos
plombier	...a domicile · ...quatre bornes · ...vacoas

Mauritius: people mix French and English. Kreol ("lwe loto", "lwe loto", "bon marse") is more spoken and social than than typed.

Short vs long-tail keywords

hotel mauritius · huge volume · very hard (Booking, Expedia, big resorts) · vague intent

hotel grand baie · medium volume · hard

hotel grand baie all inclusive · clearer need

**family guesthouse with pool near
trou aux biches beach** · small volume ·
easy · ready to book

Small businesses win on the bottom of this list first. Ten long-tail keywords with 20 searches each often bring more bookings than one head keyword you never rank for.

What makes a business rank

Visibility on Google, Maps and AI answers

TECHNICAL

Can Google get in?

Fast, mobile-friendly, https, indexed, sitemap, no broken pages.

ON-PAGE

Does Google understand?

Keywords, titles, headings, helpful content, images, internal links.

OFF-PAGE

Does the web trust you?

Reviews, backlinks, mentions, listings, social proof.

LOCAL

Are you on the map?

Google Business Profile, same name, address and phone everywhere, local reviews.

Foundation: content written for real people, in their language (EN · FR · Kreol)

Your shop window on Google

Lagon Bleu Guesthouse
<https://lagonbleu.mu> > rooms-with-pool

Family Guesthouse in Trou aux Biches with Pool | Lagon Bleu

2 min from the beach. Breakfast, free parking and family rooms. Book direct on WhatsApp for the best price.

URL

Short, readable words with the keyword.

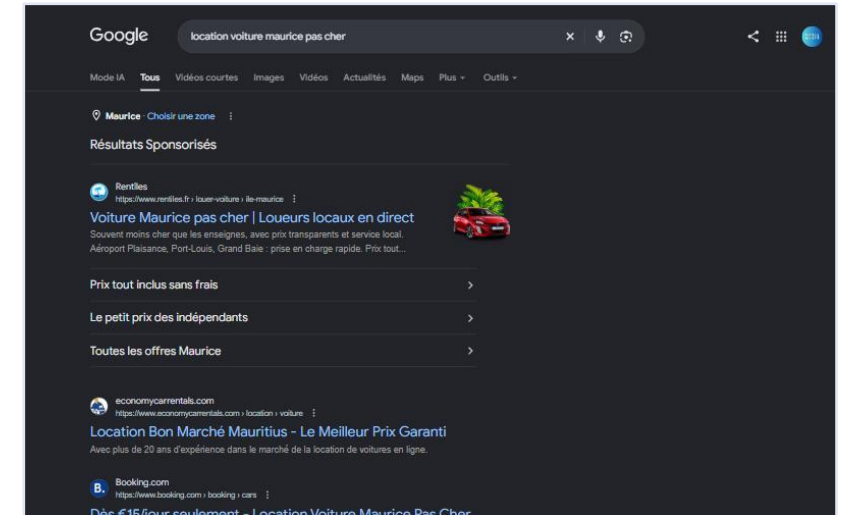
Title tag

Keyword first + place + brand. About 50–60 characters.

Meta description

Benefit + proof + call to action. About 150–160 characters.

Fictional example. Google may rewrite titles and descriptions if they don't match the page well.



"location voiture maurice pas cher":
uses the exact words people search, in French.

Title ≈ 50–60 characters · Description ≈ 150–160 · Unique for every page

5 checks anyone can do



Phone test

Open the site on your phone. Easy to read and use?



Speed

pagespeed.web.dev: fix huge images first.



Padlock

https:// and the padlock in the address bar.



Indexed?

Type site:yourdomain.mu into Google.

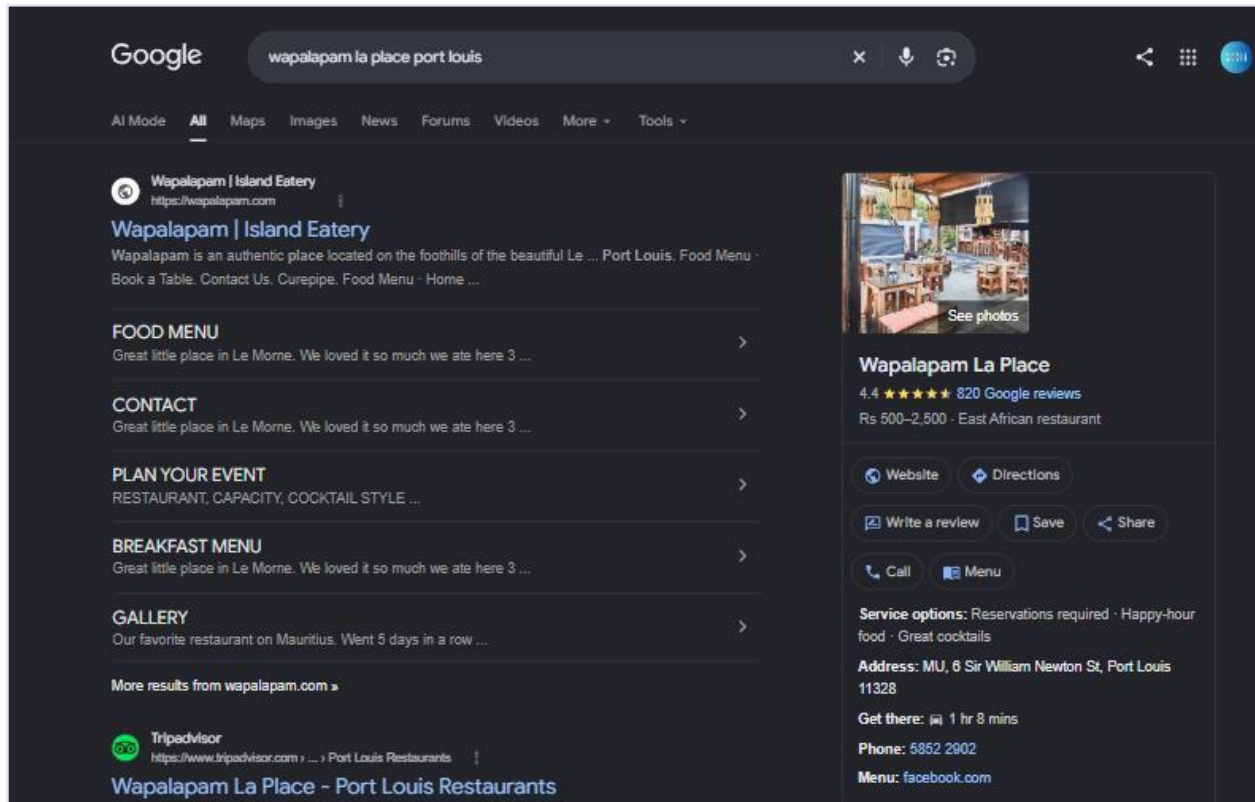


Search

Free Google tool: searches, clicks, errors.

You don't need to code. WordPress, Wix and Shopify handle most of it: your job is to check.

Google Business Profile: the quickest win



A profile in the results: photos, rating, category, buttons, hours, phone.

Relevance

Distance

Prominence

How Google ranks businesses on Maps

- Free, at business.google.com
- Name exactly as on the sign
- Precise category, hours (incl. holidays), photos monthly
- Reply to every review
- Same name, address, phone everywhere

Reviews and links: what others say



Reviews

Ask every customer at the right moment (QR code, WhatsApp link). Reply to all, good and bad, in their language. Never buy or fake reviews.



Links and mentions

Partners, suppliers, local media, associations and creators linking to you. Quality beats quantity: never buy links.

In a small market like Mauritius, reputation travels fast, online and offline.

SEO, AEO and GEO

SEO

Search Engine Optimisation

Goal: rank in the blue links and the map pack.

Where: Google, Bing, Google Maps.

Success: clicks to your site, calls, directions.

AEO

Answer Engine Optimisation

Goal: be the direct answer.

Where: featured snippets, People also ask, voice assistants, AI Overviews.

Success: your answer is shown or read out.

GEO

Generative Engine Optimisation

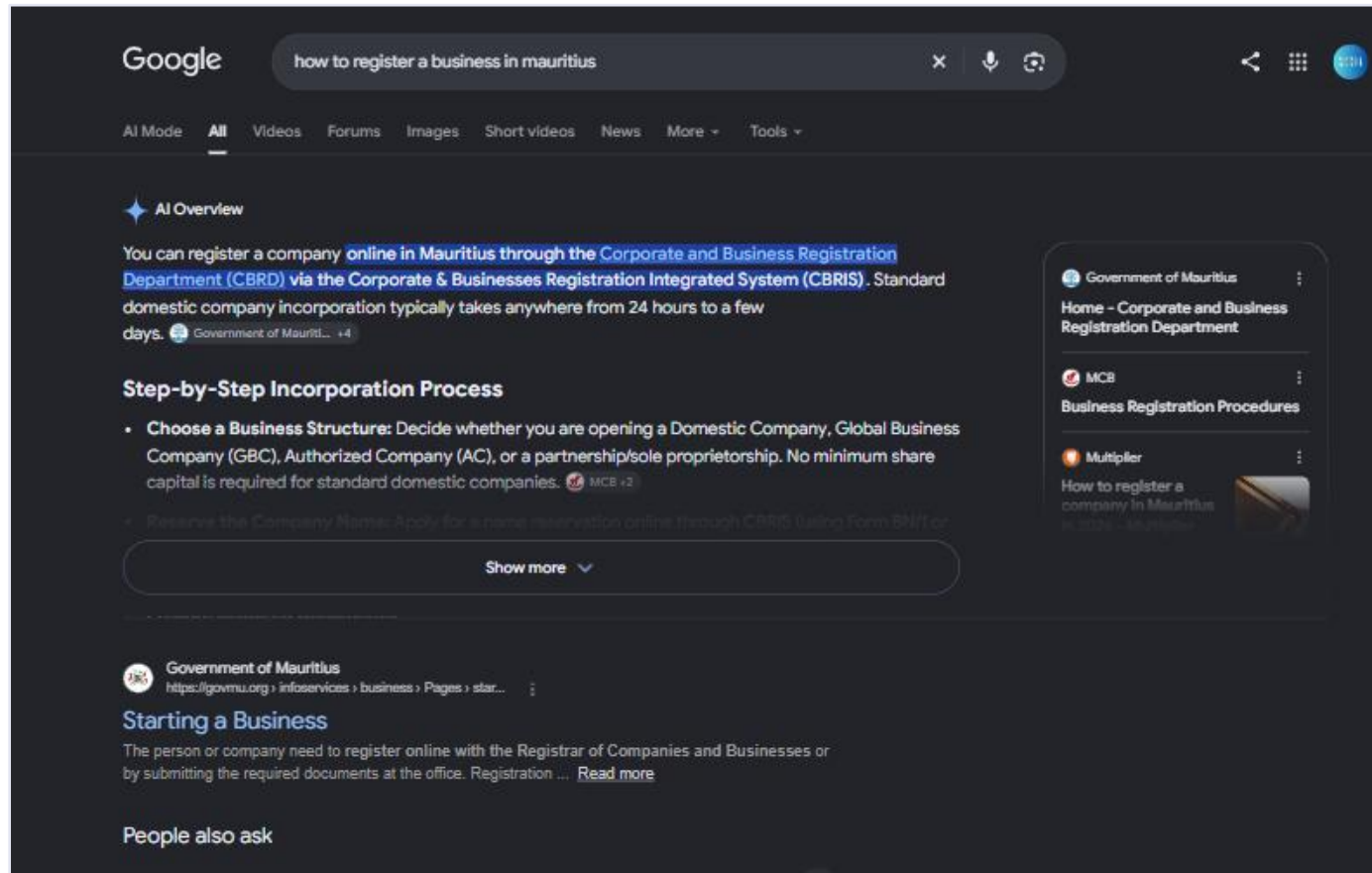
Goal: be cited or recommended by AI.

Where: ChatGPT, Gemini, Google AI Mode, Perplexity, Copilot.

Success: your brand is mentioned, linked or recommended.

Shared foundation: clear, accurate, helpful content + a trusted, consistent brand + a technically healthy site

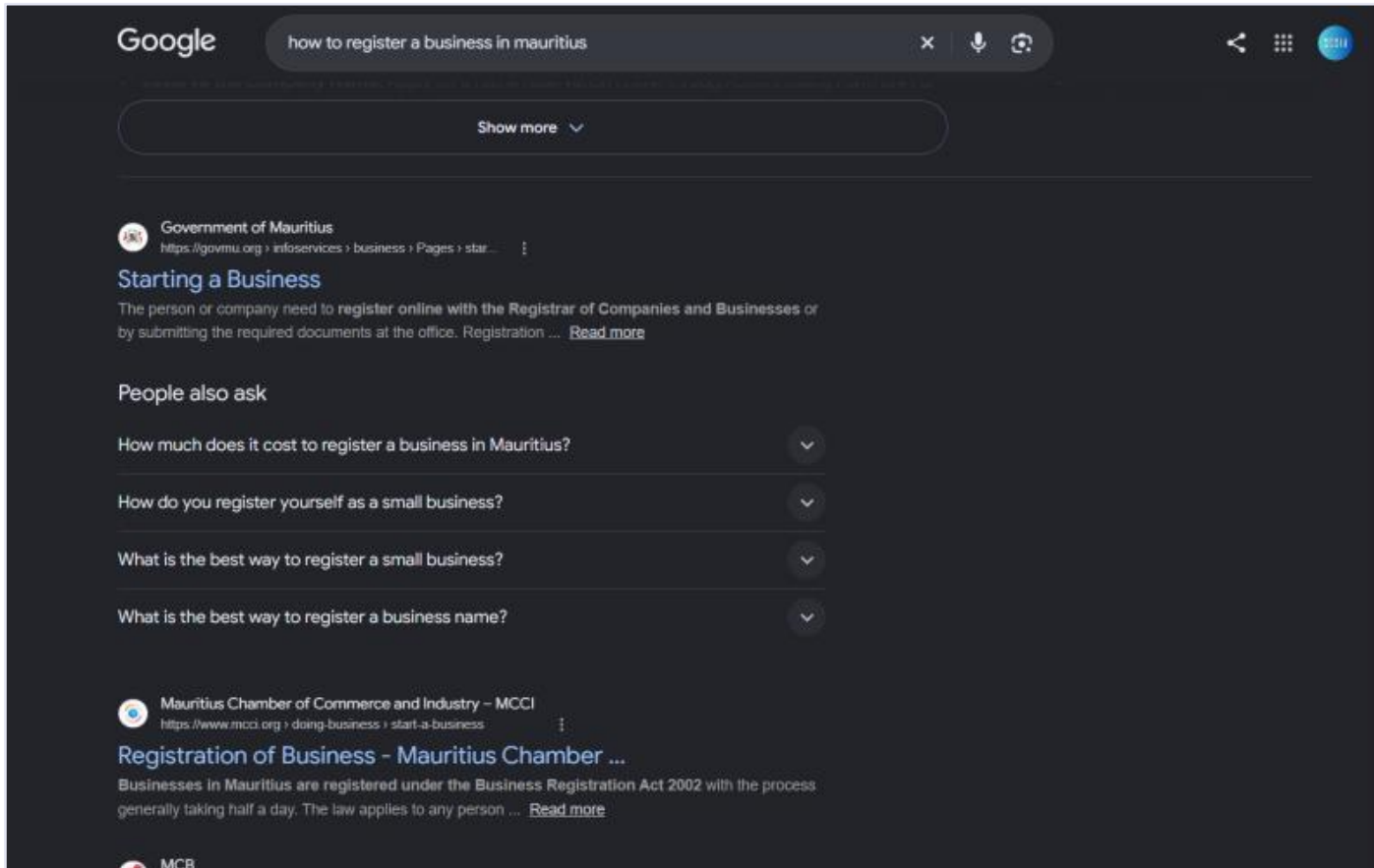
Be the answer



- Google answers with an AI Overview Overview
- Its sources: the Government of Mauritius, MCB, Multiplier
- Clear, official, structured pages quoted
- Write: question as heading → answer in the first sentence → details

google.mu · "how to register a business in mauritius"

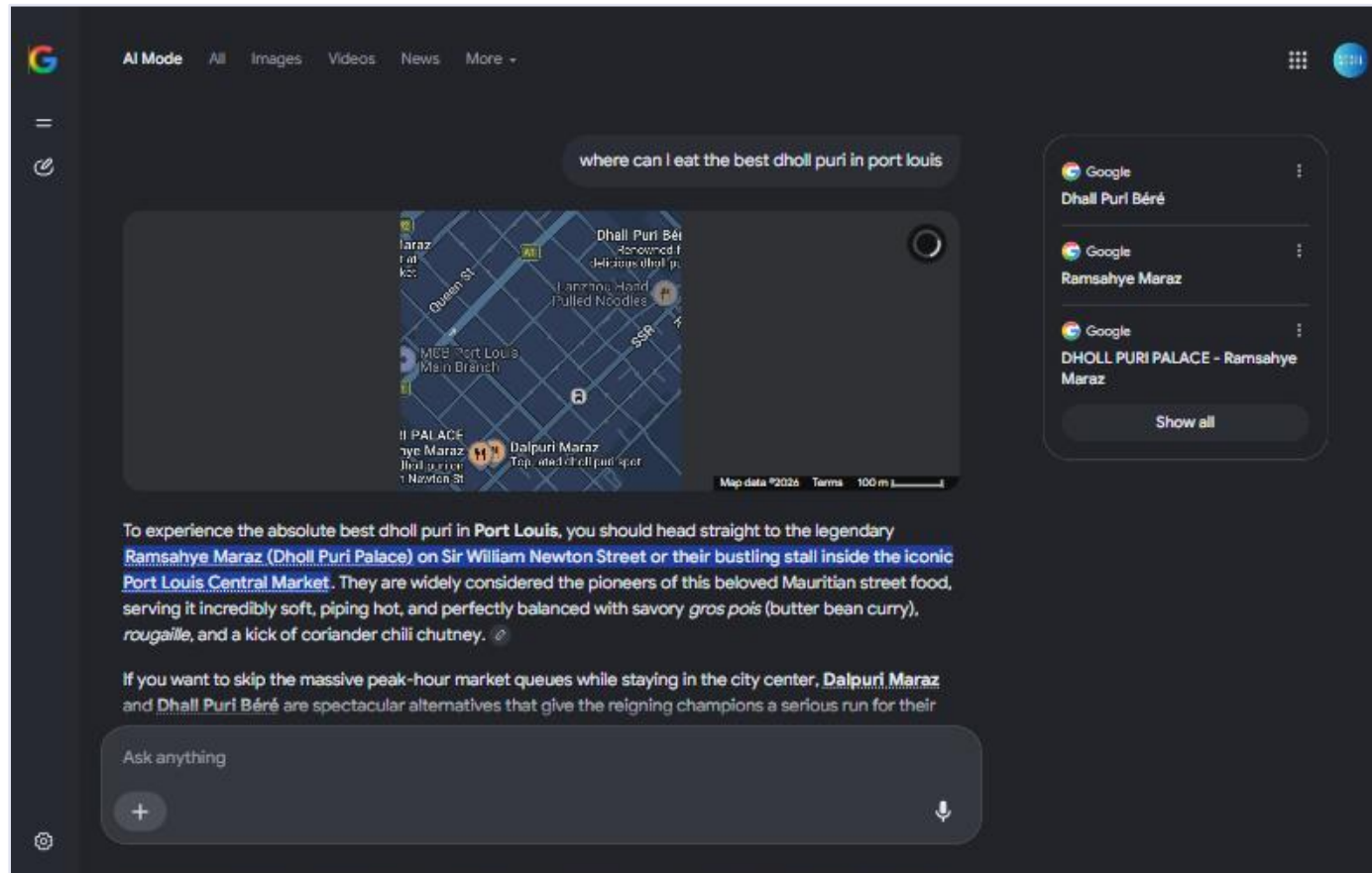
People also ask = free content ideas



- Real questions people ask, right Google
- Each one can be a heading on your page
- Answer it in the first sentence, then add details
- Below: MCCI, another trusted source

google.mu · "how to register a business in mauritius"

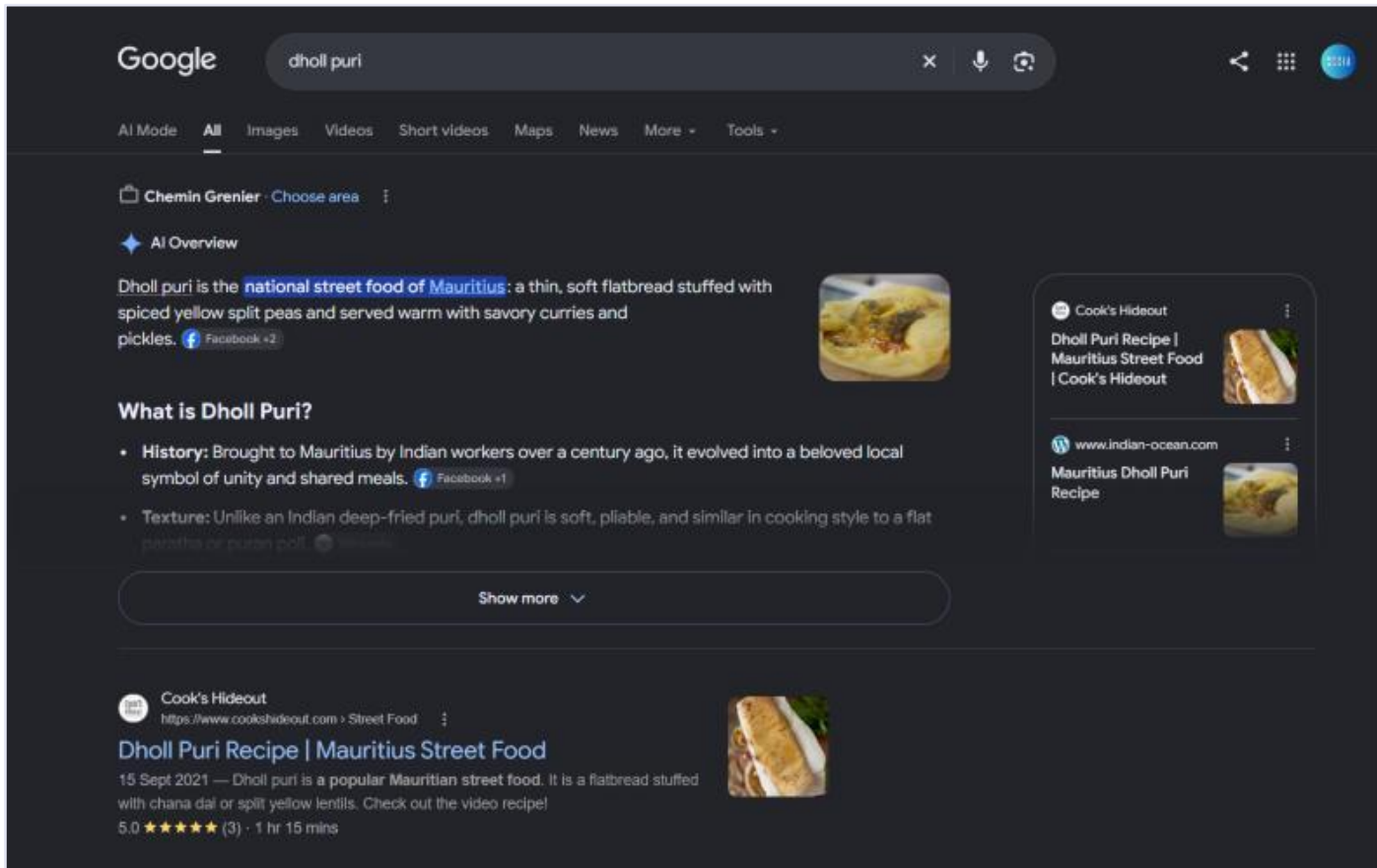
Be recommended by AI



- The AI recommends Ramsahye Maraz (Dhol Puri Palace), Dalpuri Maraz, Dhall Puri Béré
- Its sources: Google Maps listings and their reviews
- Complete profiles + reviews + consistent info = more chances to be named
- Test it: ask ChatGPT and Gemini about your business

Google AI Mode · "where can I eat the best dhol puri in port louis"

AI also reads social media



- The AI Overview cites Facebook posts and a recipe site
- AI tools use websites, Maps, reviews, social media and forums
- Be consistent everywhere: same name, details and story
- Get mentioned by others: media, creators, lists

google.mu · "dhol puri"

How long does SEO take?

Months, not days. But the traffic is free and it lasts.

WEEK 1

Fix basics

Google Business Profile, titles, Search Console, mobile.

MONTH 1-3

Get indexed

Pages appear, first Maps actions, first long-tail clicks.

MONTH 3-6

Grow

More keywords, more reviews, more content. Traffic grows.

MONTH 6-12+

Compound

Steady free traffic that keeps working without ad spend.

RECAP

5 things to remember

- 1 SEO = being found, understood and trusted
- 2 Start with the words your customers type in English, French and Kreol
- 3 Pillars: on-page, technical, local, reviews and links
- 4 In Mauritius, Google Maps is the quickest win
- 5 AI answers use the same foundation AEO: be the answer · GEO: be recommended

Your turn



EXERCISE 1 · 15 MIN

Find 15 keywords

Pick a local business. Use suggestions in English and French. Mark the intent of



EXERCISE 2 · 15 MIN

Audit a Maps profile

Find the business on Google Maps. List 5 fixes: photos, hours, category, reviews, replies.



HOMEWORK

SEO Action Plan

Read the Complete SEO Guide, then fill in the plan in Section 16. Upload it to the learning platform.